

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

**GENERAL COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST
OF INSPECTOR UNDER EXCISE & NARCOTICS DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(AUGUST-2025)**

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

SECTION - A
(64 Marks)

The questions in this Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.

Marks are indicated against each question.

1. Read the passage below and write a précis in 120-140 words giving a suitable title (14)

The modern world is full of bustle and activity. Men live in a perpetual hurry, and their minds are perpetually occupied with a thousand fleeting interests. The pressure of immediate needs and urgent tasks absorbs their attention. Reflection, solitude, and leisurely thought are becoming rare luxuries. In earlier times, particularly in simpler societies, people were more given to introspection. They lived closer to nature and closer to themselves. But now, man has become a stranger to silence, to solitude, to the inner world.

The greatest loss that this entails is the decline of independent thinking. The individual today thinks less and less for himself. His opinions are formed by mass communication—by newspapers, radio, and television. Instead of thinking, he absorbs ideas; instead of forming convictions, he repeats clichés. Public opinion is not so much the result of personal deliberation as it is a reflection of mass suggestion. True education is meant to awaken the capacity for critical thought, to teach individuals how to think rather than what to think. But unfortunately, even education has become increasingly a system of training minds to conform, rather than to inquire and dissent.

The man who dares to think independently finds himself in a difficult position. Society does not easily forgive originality. Nonconformity is often punished, either by ridicule or isolation. Yet, it is this very nonconformist, the one who questions the accepted dogmas and resists the pull of the crowd, who is often the source of progress. It was never the crowd that led the way in science, in art, or in ethics—it was always the individual. In such a world, the value of cultivating solitude and independent judgment cannot be overstated. To read great books, to converse with one's own mind, to retreat occasionally from the world's noise—these are not escapist habits but essential practices for a fully realized life. A democracy flourishes not merely by the number of people who vote, but by the quality of thought behind those votes.

2. Attempt **any one (1)** question given below:

(10×1=10)

- You are XYZ, a resident of Lungpho village, where the local Health Sub-Centre lacks essential medical equipment and staff. Write a letter to the Director of Health Services requesting urgent upgradation of the centre and suggesting practical measures to improve rural healthcare delivery.

OR

- You are ABC living in XYZ locality, Aizawl. Write a letter to the Municipal Commissioner, AMC complaining about poor sanitation in your area and give a suggestion for proper garbage disposal.

3. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given below:

India is chiefly an agricultural land. The cultivation of crops depends on a proper supply of water throughout the year. Since olden times, large parts of our country have suffered from occasional periods of too much rain and those of drought. People had known that if surplus flood water could be stored away for use during the dry season, these problems will be solved. Unfortunately, they had neither the knowledge nor the means to do so much in this direction. Whatever little they knew, they tried to put into practice. They dug canals to drain water from perennial rivers. This was heavy and expensive work and practicable over only a small area. Large tanks were excavated and small dams built to hold back floods. But it was not possible to do anything on a countrywide scale.

- (a) How has our country suffered since olden times? **(2)**
- (b) What did the people do to avoid this suffering? **(2)**
- (c) What obstacles did they face? **(2)**
- (d) Give the central idea of the passage. **(2)**
- (e) Write out the words from the passage which have the same meaning as of the expressions below: **(2×1=2)**
 - (i) Want of rain
 - (ii) Flowing throughout year

4. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of verbs.

(10×1=10)

- (a) We _____ our breakfast half an hour ago. (*finished / have finished*)
- (b) They _____ Paris last year. (*visited / have visited*)
- (c) I _____ Physics for five years. (*am studying / have been studying*)
- (d) This paper _____ twice weekly. (*is appearing/appears*)
- (e) By the end of next week, I _____ here for three years. (*will have worked / will work*)
- (f) When I saw him, he _____ chess. (*is playing / was playing*)
- (g) I _____ my assignment when my father came to pick me up. (*had done / will do*)
- (h) The earth _____ around the sun. (*revolved / revolves*)
- (i) This time tomorrow I _____ Wimbledon in England. (*will be watching/will watch*)
- (j) It started to rain while we _____ football. (*were playing / play*)

5. Fill in the blanks with the correct tense form of the verb provided in brackets. Ensure correct subject–verb agreement and tense logic. (6×1=6)

- (a) By the time we reached the station, the train already ____ (*leave*).
- (b) She ____ (*study*) environmental law for two years before switching to public policy.
- (c) If he ____ (*be*) more careful, he wouldn't have made that error.
- (d) While the meeting ____ (*go*) on, several staff members slipped out.
- (e) This time next year, I ____ (*work*) in a different department.
- (f) The agenda papers ____ (*not submit*) to the committee yet.

6. Rewrite the following sentences as directed. (10×1=10)

- (a) I can prove that this fact is true. (*into compound sentence*)
- (b) He was so tired that he could not stand. (*into simple sentence*)
- (c) Run and you will be in time. (*into complex sentence*)
- (d) The earth is round and we can prove it. (*into complex sentence*)
- (e) He said to me, "I shall come to you tomorrow". (*into indirect speech*)
- (f) Close the door at once. (*change the voice*)
- (g) Every man makes mistakes sometimes. (*into negative sentence*)
- (h) If only I were young again. (*into assertive sentence*)
- (i) It is hard to believe that he did such a deed. (*into exclamatory sentence*)
- (j) I shall never forget those happy days. (*into interrogative sentence*)

7. Answer the questions as directed: (4×1 = 4)

- (a) I am not sure **whether he will agree or not.**
(Label the underlined part as noun/ adverb clause or noun/adverb phrase etc.)
- (b) We waited **until the rain stopped.**
(Label the underlined part as noun/ adverb clause or noun/adverb phrase etc.)
- (c) **Being tired,** he declined the invitation.
(Label the underlined part as noun/ adverb clause or noun/adverb phrase etc.)
- (d) The teacher said, "Be punctual in class."
(Rewrite in indirect speech)

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice Questions) (36Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.

*The questions in this Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 10) : Identify the parts of speech of the underlined words in the given sentences:

1. This is what I want.
(a) Preposition (b) Adverb
(c) Pronoun (d) Noun
2. This is an absolute truth.
(a) Adverb (b) Noun
(c) Interjection (d) Adjective
3. What are the latest tidings?
(a) Conjunction (b) Verb
(c) Noun (d) Pronoun
4. Oh! That I had the wings of a bird.
(a) Adjective (b) Interjection
(c) Verb (d) Adverb
5. This information is all wrong.
(a) Preposition (b) Verb
(c) Noun (d) Conjunction
6. It is too hot to go out.
(a) Pronoun (b) Adverb
(c) Interjection (d) Adjective
7. Besides clothes, I gave him money.
(a) Conjunction (b) Preposition
(c) Verb (d) Noun
8. The player kicked the ball.
(a) Verb (b) Noun
(c) Interjection (d) Preposition
9. Ours is the last house in the street.
(a) Preposition (b) Adjective
(c) Interjection (d) Conjunction
10. These mangoes are almost ripe.
(a) Adverb (b) Noun
(c) Pronoun (d) Verb

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 20) : Choose an appropriate Preposition for the following sentences.

11. The court has absolved him _____ all the charges leveled against him.

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|--------|----------|
| (a) of | (b) from |
| (c) to | (d) upon |

12. Consequent upon heavy loss he is worse _____ these days.

- | | |
|----------|---------|
| (a) upon | (b) off |
| (c) to | (d) on |

13. I shall stay here _____ Friday.

- | | |
|--------|----------|
| (a) in | (b) for |
| (c) by | (d) till |

14. She was overcome _____ fatigue and went to bed.

- | | |
|--------|---------|
| (a) by | (b) to |
| (c) on | (d) for |

15. She swam _____ the river to the other side.

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|------------|----------|
| (a) to | (b) over |
| (c) across | (d) in |

16. The rain water seeps _____ the ground.

- | | |
|----------|-----------|
| (a) over | (b) under |
| (c) to | (d) for |

17. He piques himself _____ his artistic taste.

- | | |
|--------|--------|
| (a) on | (b) at |
| (c) by | (d) of |

18. His head is teeming _____ brilliant ideas.

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|----------|--------|
| (a) by | (b) to |
| (c) with | (d) of |

19. Extremism is detrimental _____ the progress of the country.

- | | |
|----------|---------|
| (a) to | (b) for |
| (c) with | (d) at |

20. The property was divided _____ the two brothers.

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|-----------|-------------|
| (a) among | (b) to |
| (c) at | (d) between |

Direction (Question Nos 21 - 28) : Choose the Correct Word or Phrase to Complete the Sentence:

21. The proposal, though initially appealing, was ultimately rejected due to its ____ assumptions about the market.
(a) arbitrary (b) objective
(c) hypothetical (d) flawed
22. Despite his public apology, the minister's explanation failed to ____ the growing public anger.
(a) escalate (b) pacify
(c) obscure (d) deflect
23. She took the comment as a personal insult, even though none was ____ intended.
(a) directly (b) deliberately
(c) truthfully (d) explicitly
24. The report was dismissed as being full of vague generalizations and lacked ____ evidence.
(a) circumstantial (b) empirical
(c) verbal (d) anecdotal
25. The new officer's approach was admired for being ____ but firm, avoiding unnecessary confrontation.
(a) passive (b) lenient
(c) tactful (d) submissive
26. The company's decision to withdraw from the project was not strategic but rather a result of ____ financial planning.
(a) astute (b) dispassionate
(c) poor (d) speculative
27. Her statement was so ____ that it could be interpreted in several ways, depending on the context.
(a) direct (b) rigid
(c) vague (d) ambiguous
28. Although he had the facts on his side, his ____ tone alienated even those who agreed with him.
(a) assertive (b) persuasive
(c) formal (d) condescending

Direction (Question Nos. 29 - 36) : Choose the correct option in each case:

29. Which of the following words is closest in meaning to 'precarious'?
(a) predictable (b) temporary
(c) dangerous (d) unstable
30. Mitigate is to damage as:
(a) aggravate is to pain (b) exaggerate is to story
(c) ease is to burden (d) inflict is to wound

31. Which sentence best uses the word '*impartial*'?
- (a) He was impartial to her feelings.
 - (b) The referee made an impartial call.
 - (c) She expressed her impartial love for sweets.
 - (d) The manager showed impartiality by promoting only her relatives.
32. Choose the option in which '*allege*' is used correctly.
- (a) The witness alleged the facts with strong evidence.
 - (b) The accused was alleged guilty without trial.
 - (c) The newspaper alleged that corruption had occurred.
 - (d) He alleged a prize for his honesty.
33. What is the antonym of '*consensus*' in the context of group decisions?
- (a) Approval
 - (b) Disagreement
 - (c) Accord
 - (d) Harmony
34. Which word best fits the sentence:
'*He was widely ____ for his honesty and dedication to duty.*'
- (a) alleged
 - (b) dissenting
 - (c) mitigated
 - (d) acclaimed
35. '*Dissent*' is most opposite in meaning to:
- (a) Object
 - (b) Concur
 - (c) Challenge
 - (d) Protest
36. Which word best fits the sentence:
'*The judge's decision was widely considered ____ because it balanced law with compassion.*'
- (a) arbitrary
 - (b) biased
 - (c) lenient
 - (d) judicious

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